

# HARIAKSHA GUNDA

## Curriculum Vitae

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### EDUCATION

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#### The University of Alabama

B.S. IN DATA SCIENCE

Tuscaloosa, AL

08/2022 – 05/2027

- Minors: Mathematics, Computer Science, Economics
- Relevant Coursework: Development Economics, Non-Linear Optimization Theory, Real Analysis I-II, Machine Learning, Database Management Systems
- GPA: 4.00/4.00

#### The University of Alabama

B.A. IN FOREIGN LANGUAGES AND LITERATURE

Tuscaloosa, AL

08/2022 – 05/2027

- Concentration: German Language and Literature
- Minors: International Studies, Public Policy Studies, Global and Cultural Perspectives
- Relevant Coursework: Issues in Global Governance, Environmental Decision-Making, International Social Work, American Public Policy
- GPA: 4.00/4.00

### EXPERIENCE

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Research Assistant, UA Culverhouse College of Business

01/2024 – Present

Research Assistant, The University of Chicago

06/2026 – 07/2026

Visiting Researcher, Paderborn Research Center for Sustainable Economy

05/2025 - 08/2025

Data Scientist, Planet Indonesia International

12/2024 - 04/2025

Research Assistant, UA Digital Forensics and Cyber Security Lab

08/2023 - 12/2023

Data Scientist, Alabama Department of Public Health Center for Health Statistics

05/2023 - 06/2023

### HONORS AND AWARDS

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Ambassador, Institute for Economics and Peace

04/2026 – Present

Scholarship (7x, applied each semester), Zeta Psi Educational Foundation

01/2023 – 03/2026

REAL List: Global and Intercultural Learning Top 25, The University of Alabama

12/2025

Microsoft Emerging Leader, Microsoft Security

04/2025 – Present

Gilman Scholars Brussels EU Study Tour Selection, US Department of State

06/2025

National Award for Undergraduates of German, German National Honor Society

04/2025

Gilman Research Scholarship, US Department of State

12/2024 - 08/2025

Boren Scholarship, US Department of Defense

04/2024 - 04/2025

Outstanding Cultural Organization, UA (associated with South Asian Culture Club)

04/2024

Critical Language Scholarship, US Department of State (declined)

03/2024

Excellence Second-Year, University of Alabama German Department

04/2023

Best Event Award, UA (associated with South Asian Culture Club Mock Shaadi)

04/2023

Children of Associates Premier Scholarship (3x), H&R Block

09/2022 – 09/2023

Crimson Scholar, The University of Alabama

08/2022 – 05/2024

National Merit Finalist Scholarship, National Merit Scholarship Corporation

04/2022

### PRESENTATIONS

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#### Oral Presentations

Paderborn Research Center for Sustainable Economy Brown Bag Seminar. August 2025. *The Economics of Data Privacy: Regulatory Uncertainty and Corporate Responses to the EU GDPR*

Planet Indonesia International Intern Symposium. April 2025. *Marine Environmental Risk Assessments for Indonesian Provinces using Data on Ecology and Socio-economic and Environmental Resilience*

State University of Malang Student Seminars. December 2024. *Assessment of Marine Environmental Risks in Indonesia*

## Poster Presentations

University of Alabama Undergraduate Research and Creative Activity Conference. April 2026. *The Heat Is On: Causal Impacts of Wildfires on Conflict Probability and Intensity in Indonesia*

University of Alabama Undergraduate Research and Creative Activity Conference. April 2026. *The Economics of Data Privacy: Regulatory Uncertainty and Corporate Responses to the EU GDPR*

University of Alabama Undergraduate Research and Creative Activity Conference. March 2024. *The Impact of Linguistic Features on Revenues using NLP on Mission Statements of Tax-Exempt Organizations*

## CERTIFICATIONS AND SPECIAL LEARNING

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|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------|
| <b>Documenting Development Data Using Metadata Standards</b> , The World Bank Group   | 08/2026 |
| <b>Responsible AI in a Global Context</b> , United Nations University                 | 07/2026 |
| <b>How Tech Drives Sustainability</b> , LinkedIn Learning                             | 06/2026 |
| <b>IEP Ambassador Seminars</b> , Institute for Economics and Peace                    | 05/2026 |
| <b>Positive Peace Academy</b> , Institute for Economics and Peace                     | 02/2026 |
| <b>Microsoft Emerging Leader Professional Development Series</b> , Microsoft Security | 08/2025 |
| <b>Climate Catalysts Mentorship Program</b> , UNFCCC                                  | 05/2025 |
| <b>Becoming a Climate Champion</b> , UNITAR                                           | 04/2025 |
| <b>Digital4Sustainability Learning Path</b> , UNSSC                                   | 03/2025 |
| <b>Supervised Machine Learning: Regression and Classification</b> , DeepLearning.AI   | 02/2025 |
| <b>AI For Everyone</b> , DeepLearning.AI                                              | 01/2024 |
| <b>Cybersecurity Foundations Specialization</b> , InfoSEC                             | 05/2023 |
| <b>Python Essential Training</b> , LinkedIn Learning                                  | 11/2022 |

## PROJECTS

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|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| <b>The University of Alabama</b><br>CO-INVESTIGATOR WITH DR. MICHAEL PRICE                                              | 01/2026 – Present<br><i>Working Paper</i>    |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Causal Impacts of Wildfires on Social Unrest in Indonesia</li></ul>             |                                              |
| <b>The University of Chicago, The University of Alabama, The University of Toronto</b><br>Present                       | 10/2025 – Present                            |
| RESEARCH ASSISTANT TO DR. JOHN LIST, DR. MICHAEL PRICE, AND DR. ANGELA DOKU                                             | <i>Working Paper</i>                         |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Sentiment Analysis of Climate Disaster News Articles in the USA</li></ul>       |                                              |
| <b>The University of Alabama</b><br>RESEARCH ASSISTANT TO DR. MICHAEL PRICE                                             | 01/2024 – 05/2024<br><i>No longer active</i> |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Impact of Mission Statement Linguistic Features on Nonprofit Revenues</li></ul> |                                              |
| <b>ZEW Mannheim, The University of Alabama</b><br>RESEARCH ASSISTANT TO DR. MARTIN KESTERNICH AND DR. MICHAEL PRICE     | 05/2025 – 08/2025<br><i>No longer active</i> |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• The Effects of GDPR on Firm Behavior and Innovation</li></ul>                   |                                              |
| <b>Planet Indonesia International</b><br>DATA SCIENTIST WITH ADAM MILLER                                                | 12/2024 – 04/2025<br><i>Completed</i>        |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"><li>• Marine Environmental Risk Assessments for Indonesian Provinces</li></ul>        |                                              |

## EXTRACURRICULARS AND AFFILIATIONS

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|---------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------|
| <b>Research Ambassador</b> , UA Office of Undergraduate Research          | 04/2026 – 05/2027 |
| <b>Member</b> , Blue Key Honor Society                                    | 04/2026 – Present |
| <b>Member</b> , Phi Kappa Phi Honor Society                               | 04/2026 – Present |
| <b>Member</b> , Pi Mu Epsilon, the National Honor Society for Mathematics | 04/2026 – Present |
| <b>Member</b> , UA Philomathic Literary Society                           | 03/2026 – 05/2027 |
| <b>Member</b> , UA Education Abroad Alumni Association                    | 03/2026 – Present |

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| <b>President</b> , United Nations Association of the USA at UA                  | 08/2025 – 05/2026 |
| <b>Technology Mechanisms Working Group Member</b> , UNFCCC YOUNGO               | 06/2025 – Present |
| <b>Member</b> , United Nations Association of the USA                           | 06/2025 – 06/2026 |
| <b>Member</b> , Asian Environmental Youth Network                               | 06/2025 – Present |
| <b>Data Volunteer</b> , Oxford Net Zero Tracker                                 | 05/2025 – Present |
| <b>Member</b> , Delta Phi Alpha (German National Honor Society)                 | 05/2024 – Present |
| <b>Member</b> , National Security Education Program (NSEP) Alumni Association   | 05/2024 – Present |
| <b>Honors College Ambassador</b> , UA Honors College                            | 03/2024 – 05/2027 |
| <b>Scholarship Officer</b> , Zeta Psi International Fraternity                  | 01/2023 – 05/2027 |
| <b>Member</b> , Golden Key Honor Society                                        | 09/2022 – Present |
| <b>Secretary &amp; Advisor</b> , UA South Asian Culture Club                    | 08/2022 – 05/2027 |
| <b>Member</b> , Association for Computing Machinery                             | 08/2022 – Present |
| <b>Member</b> , Society of Asian Scientists and Engineers                       | 08/2022 – Present |
| <b>Member</b> , UA German Club                                                  | 08/2022 – 05/2027 |
| <b>Choreographer, Teacher, Dancer</b> , Nach Basanti (Indian fusion dance team) | 08/2022 – 05/2027 |

## FEATURED

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### Podcasts

Put the Guidebook Down. April 2026. *Speaking the Place: How Language Changes the Way You Travel*

Put the Guidebook Down. December 2025. *The Power of a Gap Year: Breaking Out of the Linear Life Path*

### Datasets

Oxford Net Zero Tracker. September 2025. *Net Zero Stocktake 2025*

## SKILLS

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**Technical Skills:** Python, Econometrics, Field Experiments, R, SQL, MATLAB, TensorFlow, Webscraping, Database Management, Git, HTML/CSS/JS, LaTeX, Stata, QGIS

**Languages:** *German* (CEFR B1: Intermediate Professional Proficiency) | *Indonesian* (ACTFL 2: Intermediate Professional Proficiency) | *Malay* (Intermediate Professional Proficiency) | *Telugu* (Basic)